

it makes the Electronics Industry what it is today. Be it the TV, mobile phone, laptop, supercomputer or telescope fitted on a satellite – ICs have changed the world our forefathers imagined for us. For the uninitiated, the latest processor chips from Intel house more than 2.2 billion transistors on a die which is merely 52.5x45 mm in area! Courtesy: Integrated Circuits.

Internal Combustion Engine

Around the world in 80 days might have been an unimaginable feat once. Fast forward to today: you could go around the world at least 20 times in that much time! Without a doubt, internal combustion engines are one of the best inventions of mankind. From auto-rickshaws to jumbo jets – they rule the roost of transportation systems.

While its roots can be traced back to the Romans, its true potential was realized only much later in the late 18th century during the construction of artillery weapons using non-fossil fuels like gunpowder. While history is full of events that made way for today's supercars, the title of a major breakthrough can be accredited to Karl Benz (of the Mercedes-Benz fame) for his patent of a two-stroke engine and later to British engineer Edward Butler and German engineer Rudolf Diesel for creating the petrol and diesel engines, in that order. It's those engines which developed, with time, into something that gives us wings, literally.

Internal combustion engines brought about major transformations. Carts pulled by horses slowly disappeared and in came an alternative which depended on fuel and was free of health hazards. Developments led to faster speeds, which in turn boosted industrial development and here we are today – booking tickets to fly to another part of the globe in 8 hours.

